

GRAPHICS CARD OVERCLOCKING

Not as rewarding as CPU overclocking but a lot more possibilities.

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You've figured out how to overclock your CPU and your memory modules, both tend to last you a really long time. A good Intel Core i7, i9 or AMD Ryzen 7 processor will easily last more than 7 years with ease. After that they're no longer covered by their respective warranties and you can overclock them to get a few extra months or years worth of performance. Unfortunately, the same cannot be said for graphics cards if you're one who likes to crank the settings to the absolute maximum. Every two years, we see a massive bump in performance numbers for graphics cards and video game developers are more than happy to capitalise on that and provide realistic visuals in video games. All of this comes at a steep price, literally. If you want to continue enjoying games at the absolute maximum settings, then you're forced to upgrade every three years or so. On one end, you can overclock and get some extra performance but you'll still miss out on the feature upgrades that come with each generation. The same applies to CPUs but the impact isn't felt as strongly as it is with graphics cards.

You've already learnt how to overclock your computer's CPU. It might have appeared a bit complicated given all the things you have to factor for each step. Thankfully, graphics cards are much simpler to deal with and the process is

practically the same for both, AMD and NVIDIA graphics cards.

BEFORE YOU START

Like CPUs, GPUs also require a stable power supply and sufficient cooling. Thankfully, most graphics cards already sport beefy heatsinks. You can get aftermarket air coolers or even opt for a custom water cooling loop with a GPU block for the graphics card for some extra cooling. It comes down to how much of an overclock you wish to achieve and whether you intend to run the card at the high overclock on a 24x7 basis. Like CPUs, graphics cards also have tiers based on how well the GPU at the heart of the graphics card was binned. The flagship SKUs have considerably greater headroom and come with enhanced VRM that allows for stable overlocks. So the more expensive, high-end cards overclock better compared to the mid-range and low-end cards. Most of the instructions for graphics cards are the same as those for CPUs. The only extra bit we'd like to add here is that you clean the cooling assembly on your graphics card before proceeding. All those fins can get caked up with dust within a few months, so unless your graphics card is new, we'd advise you to use a blower to

clean the card. Also ensure that there are no components blocking the intake or exhaust areas for the fan.

OVERCLOCKING YOUR GRAPHICS CARD

For graphics card overclocking, the go to software is MSI Afterburner. It has all the settings that you can manipulate to overclock your graphics card and you don't have to keep booting into your BIOS. The latest version of MSI Afterburner even has a feature called OC scanner that can find the highest stable overclock settings for your card.



MSI Afterburner is all you need

For manual overclocking, start off by running a benchmark on loop in the background or you can run the benchmark once after applying new settings. Now simply increase the fan speeds to maximum, then max out the power limit and keep the temperature limit to 90 degrees celsius. You can increase the temperature limit if you have a better cooling solution. Then simply increase